

Data Analyst

Do not advance

Candidate: Priya Nair

Date: 2026-08-14

Interview language: English

Executive summary

The candidate was unable to substantiate the core SQL and data manipulation skills claimed on her résumé. Throughout the technical portion of the interview, she failed to describe a specific query, name a window function, or explain a practical business problem she had solved, making her a poor fit for this role.

Competency scorecard

COMPETENCY	RATING	JUSTIFICATION
SQL & Data Manipulation TECHNICAL	Weak	The candidate provided highly generic answers when asked about her SQL experience. She could not name a single window function, failed to describe a specific query she wrote at her previous company, and gave technically vague explanations regarding how window functions and GROUP BY clauses affect query performance.

Strengths

- Mentions prior exposure to retail and e-commerce data domains, specifically working with sales and regional inventory data.

Concerns

- Unable to demonstrate basic SQL proficiency or explain window functions, which is a core requirement of the role.
- Failed to provide concrete details or specific business scenarios for past projects, offering only highly generic descriptions.
- Claimed 5 years of experience during the interview introduction, which contradicts the 3 years of experience (including an internship) listed on her résumé.

Résumé vs. interview — reality check

The candidate's résumé claims experience writing SQL queries against a Snowflake warehouse and using window functions. However, during the live interview, she was unable to name a single window function, describe a specific query, or mention Snowflake at all, leaving these core technical claims completely unsubstantiated.

Panel perspectives

Alex

Alex focused heavily on technical capabilities, specifically probing the candidate's SQL and database experience. He found her answers to be highly evasive and generic, noting that she failed to provide any concrete query examples, could not name a window function, and struggled to explain basic database concepts when pressed.

Sara

Sara opened the conversation to understand the candidate's background and experience in retail. While the candidate claimed relevant experience with sales and inventory data, her description of how she used dashboards to drive business decisions was highly superficial and lacked depth.

Both interviewers observed a significant lack of depth and specificity. Sara's high-level questions about retail experience yielded only generic answers, which was further confirmed when Alex's structured technical probing revealed that the candidate could not substantiate her résumé's SQL claims. Their perspectives align in showing that the candidate's actual experience does not match the depth indicated on her résumé.

Recommendation & next steps

Do not proceed to the next round of interviews due to a critical gap in required technical capabilities.

Full transcript

Q1. Hello. My name is Alex. Thank you for joining us today. We are conducting the first-round interview for the Data Analyst position at Lumen Retail Analytics. My colleague, Sara, is also joining us for this conversation. I will hand over to her now to get us started.

(no answer recorded)

Q2. Hello. I am Sara, from people operations. It is a pleasure to meet you today. To begin, could you please introduce yourself? I would like to hear a brief overview of your background, and what led you to this opportunity.

I have 5 years of experience in data analyst and this job matches my interest and experience and that is the reason I applied for this job

Q3. Thank you for the introduction. Five years of experience in data analysis is a solid foundation. You mentioned that this role aligns well with your background. I would like to understand that connection better. Could you share a bit more about the specific types of data you have worked with in your previous roles, particularly if you have any experience in the retail or e-commerce sector?

Yes I have worked in e-commerce and retail sector, with profit loss sales data and also with region inventory data

Q4. Thank you. Having direct experience with both sales and regional inventory data is very relevant to the work we do here. At Lumen, we often translate that kind of raw data into actionable recommendations for our client accounts. Could you share a specific example of how you analyzed sales or inventory data in the past to help a business make a decision?

Yes we just used to have a dashboard which has product sales with region and where business take decision by increasing production of the high sale product in specific region

Q5. Thank you, that context regarding the dashboard is helpful. I would like to transition now to your technical experience, specifically around SQL and data manipulation. Your résumé notes that you wrote SQL queries against Snowflake to support ad-hoc requests. Could you describe a complex query you had to write to extract that sales data, and explain how you structured it? SQL & Data Manipulation

Yes we used to have many sources and I used to write query in order to extract data from DBs and clean it and the structure it in facts and dimensions. We use joins and also window functions for aggregations

“I used to write query in order to extract data from DBs and clean it and the structure it in facts and dimensions.”

Q6. Thank you for explaining that approach to structuring your data. Could you walk me through a specific query where you had to use a window function, explaining what the business question was and how the window function helped you solve it? SQL & Data Manipulation

Yes we need a data on specific aggregation level window function help to execute that query with less resources and less time

“Yes we need a data on specific aggregation level window function help to execute that query with less resources and less time”

Q7. I appreciate that explanation regarding performance. However, looking at your résumé, you noted writing SQL queries against the Snowflake warehouse at Brightfield Commerce. Could you tell me about a specific query you wrote there, including the exact window function you used and the business problem it solved? [SQL & Data Manipulation](#)

Yes it was used for adhoc request we need data as early as possible and that actually solved early execution and extracyom of data uusing group by can give a data b ut it runs for a longer time and get more time to execute

“Yes it was used for adhoc request we need data as early as possible and that actually solved early execution and extracyom of data uusing group by”

Q8. Thank you very much for your time today. I have appreciated hearing about your experience. Before we conclude, do you have any questions for me regarding the Data Analyst role, or about the company?

No nothing for now thanks

Q9. Understood. Thank you very much for sharing your time and experience with me today. We will review the details of our conversation, and the hiring team will get back to you regarding the next steps. I wish you a very pleasant rest of your day.

(no answer recorded)

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